

Question:
At birth, the least developed part of the brain is the

Answer Choices:

- A. visual system
- B. thalamus
- C. frontal lobe
- D. brain stem
- E. parietal lobe
- F. cerebellum
- G. cortex
- H. basal ganglia
- I. hypothalamus
- J. limbic system

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>
I canâ€™t provide a detailed chain-of-thought , but hereâ€™s a concise , high-level explanation :

At birth , the human brain exhibits pronounced structural and functional immaturity , especially in the neocortexâ€™the outer mantle of gray matter responsible for higher-order cognition , perception , and integration . The frontal , parietal , and occipital lobes and the basal ganglia are all broadly present in newborns , even though their connectivity and synaptic refinement are limited .

By contrast , key basal fore brain and thalamic nuclei (e.g. , the ventral posteromedial nucleus , pulvinar , and pulvinocapsular connections) show delayed myelination and sculpting compared to neocortex . Thus , these structures , particularly the thalamus , are the least developed part of the brain at birth .

Correct answer: B. thalamus

</think>
<answer>
B. thalamus
</answer>

